Heathkit SB-102 Transceiver — Restoration Plan

Rev. 2 — checked against the original Heath manual (595-1058-06)

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Safety (manual p. 100). “Lethal voltages are present both above and below the chassis.” The HP-23 delivers about **+800 V** (meter reads +800 to +900 V on HV) to the finals, and that voltage stays on the supply filter capacitors after unplugging. Ground the chassis ground bolt to a good earth ground and to all test equipment. Discharge before every hands-in session; never run the final cage open; work one-handed when live. Use a **50 Ω non-reactive dummy load rated for 100 W, never light bulbs** (p. 101). **Never pull a tube or pilot lamp with power on.** The series-parallel filament string can take out other tubes (p. 122).

1. Source documents

Document	Where	Use
Heath SB-102 Assembly Manual, 595-1058-06 (©1970)	W5RKL (w5rkl.com/manuals)	**Primary reference.** Page numbers below are the manual’s printed pages.
SB-102 solid-state LMO schematic	archive.org (K6KJN upload)	LMO internals (the manual omits them).
SB-102 Service Bulletins -1 … -30 (1970–84)	Heath list (puck.nether.net), Aug 1997 / Apr 1998	Factory fixes; many refer to SB-100, SB-101 and HW-100/101 bulletins.
W5RKL, *Heathkit HW-101 and SB-10x Restoration and Troubleshooting*	w5rkl.com	Field practice.
K5BCQ SB-101/102 repair site	qsl.net/k5bcq	Leakage limits, IF centering, dial mechanics.
Nostalgic Kits Central SB-10x troubleshooting	nostalgickitscentral.com	Measured SB-102 resistor drift and electrolytic leakage.
W2PA SB-101 rebuild notes	sites.google.com/site/radiow2pa	LMO connector, bandswitch rotors, driver neutralizing.
Heath list / Heathkit-Radios / heathkit (groups.io)	puck.nether.net, groups.io	Field experience.

Designator groups (p. 135):

Range	Board
0–99	Modulator
100–199	IF
200–299	Bandpass
300–399	Audio
400–499	RF-driver
500–599	Crystal
600–699	Heterodyne oscillator
700–799	Driver grid
800–899	Driver plate
900–999	Chassis

Resistors are 1/2 W unless marked. Voltage charts are measured with an 11 MΩ VTVM, ±20% (Figs. 1-14A/B).

2. Transceiver at a glance

2.1 Factory specifications (pp. 131–134)

Item	Spec
Coverage	3.5–4.0, 7.0–7.3, 14.0–14.5, 21.0–21.5, 28.0–30.0 MHz (eight 500 kHz segments)
Sensitivity	**< 0.35 µV** for 10 dB (S+N)/N, SSB
Selectivity	SSB 2.1 kHz @ 6 dB / 5 kHz @ 60 dB (3.395 MHz filter 404-283). CW 400 Hz / 2.0 kHz with optional **SBA-301-2**.
Audio	2 W, < 10% distortion; 8 Ω speaker and high-Z phones
Input / output	180 W PEP SSB, 170 W CW input; **100 W out on 80–15 m, 80 W on 10 m**
Carrier / sideband suppression	50 dB / 55 dB
Stability	< 100 Hz/hr after **10 min**; < 100 Hz for ±10% line
Dial	Visual within 200 Hz; **electrical within 400 Hz after calibration at the nearest 100 kHz point**; backlash < 50 Hz
ALC	Heath **TALC** (triple-action level control)
Power required	**700–850 V @ 250 mA** (1% ripple); **300 V @ 150 mA**; **−115 V @ 10 mA**; **12 V AC/DC @ 4.76 A**
Size / weight	14-7/8 × 6-5/8 × 13-3/8 in.; 17.5 lb
Built	1970–1975, $380

2.2 Tube complement (spec p. 133; V numbers from the circuit description)

V	Tube	Function	Known issues (source)
V1	6EA8	Speech amp (A) / cathode follower (B)	GE 6EA8 oscillates → VOX chatter (SB-101-19).
V2	6AU6	Isolation amp	—
V3	6AU6	1st IF amp (also the S-meter/ALC bridge)	**Brand-critical**: GE only (SB-102-24, -30). Leaky → S-meter drift (SB-101-22; chart 18E).
V4	6AU6	2nd IF amp	Same as V3.
V5	6EA8	1st transmit mixer (A) / crystal oscillator (B)	No LMO signal at pin 7 → chart 25C.
V6	6CB6	2nd transmit mixer	Under shield.
V7	6CL6	Driver	Under shield.
V8, V9	6146	Finals, class AB1	Gassy → grid drive falls off (chart 44D). Tung-Sol vs. RCA alters drive (SB-102-3).
V10	**6HS6**	Receiver RF amp	Leaky → poor AGC (SB-102-15). A 6AU6 substitutes in an emergency.
V11	**6AU6**	1st receive mixer	**Confirmed 6AU6** (Fig. 2-22, p. 151).
V12	6EA8	2nd receive mixer (A) / relay amp (B)	Bad V12B → relays won't energize (chart 37A) or stay in (SB-102-14).
V13	6BN8	AVC (A/B) / product detector (C)	Faulty → no audio (chart 13C).

V	Tube	Function	Known issues (source)
V14	6GW8	Audio amp (A) / audio power amp (B)	C304 is its B+ filter.
V15	6EA8	CW tone osc (A) / tone amp (B)	Not operating → won't key on CW (chart 33A).
V16	12AU7	Carrier oscillators: A = USB (Y1 3396.4 kHz); B = LSB (Y2 3393.6) / CW (Y3 3395.4)	Plate resistors R6/R7 33 kΩ (chart 31E).
V17	12AT7	VOX amp (A) / 100 kHz calibrator (B)	Defective → VOX won't trip (chart 40C).
V18	OA2	+150 V regulator	Bad → no regulated B+ (chart 5B).
V19	12AT7	Heterodyne osc (A) / cathode follower (B)	**Wrong type → S-meter zero problems** (chart 18H). R212 change (SB-102-2).

The spec list totals **19 tubes**; the introduction (p. 2) says "twenty tubes, four transistors, eighteen diodes", counting the LMO's internal parts. The LMO itself is transistorized; there is no VFO buffer tube.

2.3 Semiconductors (spec p. 133; parts lists pp. 4, 23)

Ref	Type (Heath p/n)	Function	Notes
CR1–CR4	1N191 Ge (56-26-1)	Balanced modulator	Wrong type or failed → no SSB output (chart 28C). SB-102-28 is a germanium diode change.
CR201	1N191 Ge	Calibrator harmonic generator	—
CR901	1N191 Ge	REL PWR sampling	—
D1, D2	Silicon 750 mA 500 PIV (57-27)	Anti-trip rectifiers	Reversed → relays stay in (chart 41B).
D101	57-27	AVC gate	**Defective → slow recovery from transmit** (chart 43).
D106	57-27	**LMO supply rectifier** (12.6 VAC → DC)	—
D201	57-27	VOX rectifier	Leaky → poor VOX (SB-101-4); reversed → no VOX (chart 40D).
D202	**15 V zener, 1 W, 1N4166A** (56-25)	Relay amp V12B cathode	Reversed or bad → relays won't trip (chart 40E).
D301	57-27	Transmit mixer/driver cutoff bias	—
D902, D903	57-27	**ALC voltage doubler**	Leaky → ALC falls off after warm-up (SB-101-4).
D904	57-27	CW keying	Shorted or open → won't key CW (chart 33C).
D905	57-27	RF-gain/AVC diode gate	Leaky → slow recovery (SB-101-4).
D907	**10 V zener** (56-67)	**LMO +10 V regulator**	**Reversed → no 10 V to the LMO** (chart 39B).
D909	1N4149 (56-56)	Receive/transmit C955 switch	—
Q1	**2N3567** (417-114)	**LMO on/off switch**, not a regulator	Open → no LMO 10 V (chart 39C); shorted → no injection (chart 34E).

2.4 LMO and its power supply (pp. 142–143)

- **LMO 110-48** is a sealed, factory-calibrated unit containing a capacity-tuned silicon transistor oscillator and a transistor bandpass amplifier. It tunes 5.0–5.5 MHz at 100 kHz per shaft turn.
  - A diode switch shifts it 2.8 kHz between LSB and USB/CW; the **LSB ADJUST** screw is on top.
  - It has an unused **FSK terminal** that gives up to about 1 kHz shift (RTTY needs a fan and reduced screen current, p. 116).
  - **"At no time should the LMO be opened or the warranty will be voided"** (p. 122).
- **Supply path:**
  1. 12.6 VAC filament → **D106** rectifier → **C941, C942 (500 µF each, 25-199)** and **R936** filter.
  2. → **pilot lamp PL1 (#1815) as a voltage-dropping element → D907 10 V zener →** about **+10 V**.
  3. For mobile operation, a jumper between pins 6 and 8 of the power socket feeds 12.6 VDC straight to PL1, bypassing D106.
- **Q1 2N3567** turns the internal LMO on when +150 V reaches its base through **R941 (68 kΩ)** (R939 47 kΩ to ground). In the AUX positions, the +150 V goes to the crystal oscillator V5B instead.
- **R928 (56 Ω)** terminates the FREQ CONTROL/LMO output line. It is **not** in the supply path.
- At first power-up, **"the lamp in the LMO power supply should glow dimly"** (p. 100).
- **Chart 39, no 10 V to the LMO:**
  - A. voltage-dropping lamp open;
  - B. zener reversed;
  - C. Q1 open;
  - D. mobile jumper missing.

2.5 Pilot lamps and supply

- **Lamps (parts list p. 24):** one **#47** and three **#1815** (one #1815 is PL1 in the LMO supply). They are part of a series-parallel filament arrangement; wrong lamps unbalance it (chart 4B). Panel lamps should light with equal brilliance (p. 100).
- **Supply (pp. 98–99):** HP-23/23A (117 VAC) or HP-13/13A (12 VDC).
  - The HP-23A must be on its **+300 V** connection.
  - **With the HP-23A, the supply's BIAS control is inoperative; bias is set by the transceiver's BIAS ADJUST.**
  - With the HP-13A, set the supply's bias control fully clockwise.
- **11-pin plug:**

Pin	Function
1	Bias −130 V
2	Ground (filament)
3	LV +300 V
4	HV +800 V
5, 11	N.O. relay (for a linear amplifier)
6	Filament 12 VAC
7	Ground (B− and bias)
8	N.C. (mobile jumper to 6)
9, 10	Supply switch

- SB-100, SB-101 and HW-100 sockets need any wire on pin 8 removed.
- **The 9-terminal jumper plug (screen supply) must be on its chassis connector** or there is no transmit (p. 100).

3. What fails, ranked

3.1 Capacitors

All seven electrolytics (parts lists pp. 4, 23; one restorer found most leaky). The parts lists give no voltage ratings; the ratings below are safe replacements.

Ref	Value (p/n)	Role (manual figure)	Replace with
C941, C942	**500 µF** (25-199), chassis	**LMO supply filter** (p. 143)	470–500 µF **≥ 35 V** (kits use 50 V)
C12	20 µF tubular (25-135), modulator	Speech-amp B+ filter, V1B (Fig. 2-6)	22 µF 450 V
C304	20 µF tubular (25-135), audio	Audio output B+ filter, V14 (Fig. 2-26)	22 µF 450 V. **Shorted or reversed → no audio** (chart 10D). One measured 3.6 mA leakage (0.5 mA allowed).
C2	10 µF (25-115), modulator	V1A cathode bypass (Fig. 2-6)	10 µF 50 V
VOX cathode bypass	10 µF (25-115), bandpass	V17A cathode (Fig. 2-3; field sources call it **C212**)	10 µF 50 V
(chassis 10 µF)	10 µF (25-147)	Chassis; field kits call it **C945**, bias filter	Confirm position and polarity on the schematic before removal; bias is a **negative** supply

Other capacitors:

Part	Likelihood	Symptom (manual ref)	Action
.2 µF resin (27-34): C213 VOX delay, C25 anti-trip, C3 and others	Medium	VOX delay drift (SB-100-3); poor anti-trip	Replace with film (kit: 0.22 µF).
.05 µF tubular (23-59), 1 µF tubular (27-19)	Medium	Leakage	Film replacements.
C4–C8, C16, C17 (carrier oscillator)	Low–medium	No carrier on LSB/USB (chart 31D)	Measure.
C208, C223, C604 (heterodyne osc)	Low–medium	No heterodyne injection (chart 36D, 36G)	Measure.
C111, C402	Low	No first-mixer output (chart 25F)	Measure.
C317	Low	Won’t key CW (chart 33B)	Measure.

Part	Likelihood	Symptom (manual ref)	Action
C14 carrier-null capacitor; C18	—	Null at a rotor extreme	**p. 104:** if it nulls fully meshed toward the LMO, remove the 12 pF mica at 18; if meshed away from the LMO, replace it with the 24 pF. Also SB-102-18.
IF transformer internal micas	Low–medium	Corroded → value change	Measure (K5BCQ).

Leakage limits (K5BCQ): < 0.01 µF ≤ 0.5 µA; 0.01–1 µF ≤ 1 µA (aged). Electrolytics: I ≤ kC + 0.3 mA, with k = 0.02 (101–250 V) or 0.035 (251–350 V).

3.2 Resistors

Measured drift in one SB-102 (Nostalgic Kits Central; 15 replaced): 100 kΩ resistors at 115 k–**851 k**; 150 kΩ at 192 k / **open**; 330 kΩ → 463 k; 22 kΩ → 42 k; 3.3 kΩ → 5.5 k; 68 kΩ → 92 k.

Ref	Value (manual figure)	Failure / symptom (manual chart)	Fix
R106	**22 kΩ 1 W**, V3 screen (Fig. 2-28)	Heats and drifts → S-meter zero wander (chart 18D)	22 kΩ 2 W wirewound or 33 kΩ 2 W (field).
R107	**100 kΩ** (Fig. 2-28)	S-meter drift (chart 18D)	100 kΩ 1 W (SB-101-9); SB-101-1 changed it to 82 kΩ, so check which is fitted.
R103, R105, R110, R115	100 kΩ, **56 Ω**, 330 Ω, 150 Ω	S-meter won't zero or shifts (chart 18D)	Measure. *(R104 and R105 are **56 Ω** in this manual, not 47 Ω as in the HW-101.)*
R6, R7	**33 kΩ**, V16 plates (Fig. 2-7)	No LSB/USB carrier (chart 31E, which also lists R8, R9, R11)	33 kΩ 1 W (kit).
R116	**4700 Ω** (Fig. 2-25, product detector)	—	Kit value 4.7 kΩ confirmed.
R212	**220 Ω** (Fig. 2-14)	Heterodyne-oscillator tube failures	330 Ω 1/2 W (SB-102-2).
R117	3300 Ω (Fig. 2-24, AVC)	Open → fast AVC decay	Replace.
R304, R305	(regulator)	No or wrong +150 V (chart 5C, 6B)	Measure.
R307	—	LMO won't shift with mode (chart 35C)	Measure.
R18, R19, R23, R24, R937, R938	—	No isolation-amp output (chart 27B)	Measure.
R915	3.3 MΩ (ALC)	Open → ALC upset	Replace.
R936	—	LMO supply filter resistor	Measure.

Ref	Value (manual figure)	Failure / symptom (manual chart)	Fix
R940	100 Ω (driver plate B+)	Burned	Replace; dress the lead from the shield.
R216, R413 etc.	—	—	Survey.

Precision **R921 / R942 (500 kΩ 1%)** are the HV meter multiplier. Replace them only with 1% parts.

Lift one lead to measure, because parallel paths mislead.

3.3 Tubes, by risk

1. **6AU6 at V3/V4:** brand matters; use GE (SB-102-24, -30).
2. **6HS6 V10:** leakage.
3. **6146 pair:** gassy tubes reduce grid drive (chart 44D); brand affects drive.
4. **6EA8 (V1, V5, V12, V15)** and **12AT7 (V17, V19).** V19 must be a 12AT7 (chart 18H).
5. **OA2 V18.**

Use a tester with a **grid-leakage** test. Put each tube back in its original socket.

3.4 LMO

Symptom	Cause	Fix (source)
LMO dead / no injection	**PL1 #1815 dropping lamp open**, D907 reversed, Q1 open, mobile jumper (chart 38–39); FREQ CONTROL switch position or its violet/orange/white coax (chart 34)	Check for about +10 V at the LMO. Replace the lamp (keep spares), recap C941/C942, check D106, D907, Q1, R936.
Instability, jumps	Chassis stress at the mounting lugs	Replace lockwashers with #6 flat washers and **hex lock nuts**; tighten criss-cross, one turn at a time (SB-102-4).
Jumps when the cable moves	Dirty LMO phono jack/plug	DeoxIT (SB-101-16; W2PA).
Dial off between 100 kHz points	Spec is within **400 Hz after calibration at the nearest 100 kHz point** (p. 132). K9STH measured 3–10 kHz on five aged units.	Recalibrate at the nearest point. Larger errors are out of spec; Heath's remedy was LMO exchange.
Zero setting changes band to band	**Calibrator not exactly on 100 kHz** (chart 45)	Re-zero the CAL XTAL trimmer against WWV.
Wrong USB/LSB shift	LSB ADJUST; R307; mode wafer 1F (chart 35)	LSB ADJUST procedure (§4.7).
Stiff tuning, slipping knob	Dial drive (100-450 assembly), rubber belts 268-7 ×3	Clean; set roller tension (K5BCQ, W2PA). The kit supplied silicone grease (352-13).

Do not open the LMO casually. If it is defective, the manual says to return it (chart 34F).

3.5 Mechanical, switches, relays

Item	Symptom	Fix (source)
Switch-wafer rotors 180° out	Dead bands, no injection, no final output	Chart 21G (driver plate board), 36I (crystal/heterodyne boards); W2PA found 3 of 4 wrong.
SSB/CW FILTER switch	Left on CW without an SBA-301-2 → no RF output, unintelligible receive	Chart 23A, 26B; clean the switch (SB-102-25).
FREQ CONTROL switch	Wrong position → no LMO or no output	Use **LOCKED NORMAL** for normal operation (chart 14M, 23B, 34B).
RL1, RL2 wiring and contacts	Many chart entries (8, 10G/H, 19, 20, 21C)	Clean the contacts (manual says relays should be trouble-free; field: RL2 carbon → chirp, SB-102-21).
Board mounting hardware and lockwashers	Receiver birdies or oscillation; transmitter instability	Lockwashers on the foil side, tight (chart 16A, 42C; p. 122). Steel comb brackets (SB-102-9/-10).
Final/loading cap hardware, coil cover, tube-shield clips	Transmit instability	Chart 42B, G, H.
Low 40 m output	Ground routing	SB-102-5.
Preselector drive	Poor tracking	Belts, bearings, cap 26-122 (SB-102-17).
Loading cap turns with plate	—	Grommet 73-3 (SB-102-20).
Final knobs or shafts loose	No RF	Chart 21H.

3.6 HP-23 power supply (do first)

- Recap the high-voltage section (C1–C4 → 150 µF 500 V).
- Recap C5 (40 µF B+). An open C5 causes a CW tone and relay chatter (SB-102-29 symptom).
- Recap the bias caps C6/C7.
- Replace the bleeders (100 kΩ 2 W) and diodes (1N4007).
- Fit a grounded cord.
- **+300 V B+ connection.**
- Must meet the spec: **700–850 V @ 250 mA, 300 V @ 150 mA, −115 V @ 10 mA, 12 V @ 4.76 A**.
- Reform or ramp on a variac over 5–10 min.

4. Restoration plan

4.1 Phase 0: Assess cold

1. Photograph everything. Note mods, wrong-value parts and tube brands.
2. Pull and label the tubes; test with a grid-leakage tester. Confirm V19 is a 12AT7.
3. Check wafer rotor orientation.
4. Inspect C304, the 2 W and 1 W resistors, RL1/RL2, belts, the LMO coax and **PL1**.
5. Run the **resistance chart, Fig. 1-15 (p. 123)**: all controls fully counterclockwise, power plug disconnected, measured to chassis. Typical points:

Point	Expected
V8/V9 grids	95 kΩ
V7	91 kΩ / 168 kΩ / 39 kΩ
V10	300 kΩ, 220 Ω
V11	2 MΩ
V3	2.1 MΩ
V4	1.9 MΩ
V13	9.2 MΩ

4.2 Phase 1: HP-23

Recap, test unloaded on a variac and wire per **Fig. 1-5 (p. 99)**.

4.3 Phase 2: Clean

DeoxIT all rotary wafers, pots, the **FILTER**, **FREQ CONTROL** and MODE switches. Keep solvents off the dial plastic.

4.4 Phase 3: Recap and resistor survey

1. Replace all **7 electrolytics** (§3.1), including C941/C942.
2. Replace the resin, tubular and Mylar caps.
3. Resistor survey board by board (audio → modulator → IF → bandpass → RF-driver → chassis), with priority on §3.2.
4. Replace suspect silicon diodes (D101, D201, D902, D903, D905).
5. Clean the relays.

4.5 Phase 4: Mechanical and LMO

Belts; comb brackets and lockwashers; LMO mounting fix (SB-102-4); clean the LMO jack; set the dial roller tension.

4.6 Phase 5: Initial test (manual p. 100)

1. Controls: FINAL (round) 80; FINAL (lever) over 50 Ω; MODE LSB; RF GAIN fully CW; FILTER SSB; others fully CCW. **BIAS ADJUST (top of chassis) fully CCW.**
2. Check the 9-terminal jumper plug is fitted. Connect the 8 Ω speaker; never run without a speaker or phones.
3. FUNCTION → PTT. Panel lamps light with **equal brilliance**; **the LMO supply lamp glows dimly.**
4. METER → HV: **+800 to +900 V**.
5. METER → PLATE: **zero**.
6. AF GAIN up: receiver noise is heard.
7. Check **+300 V** at bandpass board point 5 and **−111 V** bias at audio board point 4.
8. Compare with the **receiver and transmitter DC voltage charts**, Figs. 1-14A/B (fold-out from p. 122; ±20%; bias at 50 mA plate current). Key values:
   - B+ about 300 V;
   - V18 regulated 150 V;
   - V19 test point;
   - V5 cathode about −5 V with the crystal oscillator, 0 V with the LMO;
   - V14 plate about 245 V.

4.7 Phase 6: Alignment (manual pp. 101–105)

Equipment: high-impedance voltmeter (or a 20 kΩ/V VOM); 50 Ω 100 W non-reactive dummy load; a receiver for WWV (2.5/5/10/15 MHz) or a broadcast station on a 100 kHz multiple. A monitor scope is recommended.

Preset:

Control	Setting
CAL XTAL trimmer	Notch toward the 100 kHz crystal
DRIVER PRESELECTOR	12 o'clock
MIC/CW LEVEL	Fully CCW
MODE	LSB
BAND	3.5
Dial	3.7 MHz
FUNCTION	PTT
FREQ CONTROL	LOCKED NORMAL
RF GAIN	Fully CW
FILTER	SSB
METER	ALC
AF GAIN	9 o'clock

Do not transmit until directed.

S-meter: after warm-up, adjust **METER ZERO** (IF board, behind the FREQ CONTROL switch) for zero.

Receiver:

1. **Heterodyne oscillator:** voltmeter on −DC at **TP** (bandpass board, foil side near V19). If TP reads 0, use the adjacent lead of the 100 kΩ resistor.
   - Target is **−0.5 to −2 V on every band**. **−0.3 V means the oscillator isn't running.**
   - Adjust in the direction where the voltage changes **slowly**.
   - Coils 3.5, 14 and 28.5 are on top (RF-driver board, coil 3.5 near V11). The others are from the bottom, marked on the shield cover.
2. FUNCTION CAL, BAND 3.5, tune 3.7 MHz. Confirm the calibrator signal (it should stop in VOX and peak with the DRIVER PRESELECTOR). Reset the preselector to 12 o'clock.
3. **IF:** peak **T201** for volume, then **T102** top and bottom slugs, then **T103** for S-meter. Repeat. Don't turn T201 or T103 more than two turns.
4. **Driver grid and plate coils**, in order **3.5 → 29 (29.2) → 21 (21.2) → 14 (14.2) → 7 (7.2)**, with the preselector at each marked position, for maximum S-meter.

Benchmark (p. 103): calibrator **S9+20 dB at 3700 kHz, decreasing to S6 at 29.2 MHz.**

Receiver signal-voltage chart (fold-out p. 122) for signal-generator troubleshooting: - 3.395 MHz at 20 mV at point 1 gives 4 V RMS at the 8 Ω jack. - **100 µV at the antenna (3.900 MHz) gives about S9.** - Calibrator signal is about S9+20 dB.

Transmitter (p. 103–104; coil cover on; 100 W dummy load):

1. **Neutralizing capacitor** (on the RF cage) at **½ meshed, slot vertical**. FINAL 80; lever over 50 Ω; MODE LSB; BAND 3.5; 3.7 MHz; PTT; FILTER SSB; FREQ CONTROL LOCKED NORMAL; METER PLATE.
2. **Bias:** press PTT and set **BIAS ADJUST for 50 mA** plate current. If it reads over 100 mA, don't hold PTT more than a few seconds until it's set.
3. METER → REL PWR (RELATIVE POWER control mid-range). TUNE mode. Advance MIC/CW LEVEL until RF shows; peak the DRIVER PRESELECTOR and FINAL.

4. MIC/CW LEVEL to about **¼ maximum output**; peak **T1**. No more than one turn should be needed.
5. MIC/CW LEVEL and preselector for maximum. METER → **GRID: should read full scale.**
6. **Neutralization:**
   - METER → PLATE: tune FINAL for minimum plate current.
   - METER → REL PWR: tune for maximum.
   - Both must fall at the **same FINAL setting**. Move the neutralizing capacitor a small amount at a time until they coincide.
7. **Carrier null:** MIC/CW fully CCW; LSB, PTT. Adjust the **CARRIER NULL control**, then the **CARRIER NULL capacitor**, for minimum RF. Repeat until the null is about the same on LSB and USB, down to **¼ V or less** on an RF voltmeter. See §3.1 for the C18 12/24 pF fix. **The 6.8 MHz trap is sealed; don't turn it.**
8. **For each band from 3.5:**
   - Peak FINAL and preselector.
   - METER → GRID and set MIC/CW for about **0.3 mA**.
   - Peak **that band's heterodyne oscillator coil for maximum grid current**.
   - Advance MIC/CW for **near or over full-scale** grid.
9. **Driver neutralization (21.2 MHz):** put the free end of the **driver neutralizing wire into hole W** on the RF-driver board (Fig. 1-1). Peak the preselector; if peaking is ragged, reposition or bend the wire for smooth peaking.
10. **Final neutralization again at 14.2 MHz** (adequate for all bands).
11. **Rezero the S-meter on 29.5**, then check zero on every band. If a band doesn't read zero, readjust **that band's heterodyne oscillator coil** (chart 18A).
12. **Crystal calibrator (p. 104–105):** lay the antenna wire near Y4/V19. FUNCTION CAL, AF GAIN fully CCW. Adjust the **CAL XTAL trimmer (C220, 8–50 pF, bandpass board)** for zero beat on WWV in an external receiver; confirm by toggling VOX/CAL. **A 20 Hz error at 100 kHz becomes 740 Hz at 3.7 MHz.**
13. **LSB ADJUST:**
    - Set 3.7 MHz (BAND 3.5, upper dial at 2, circular dial at 0). FUNCTION CAL, MODE USB.
    - Zero beat and peak the preselector.
    - Switch to LSB without touching the dial.
    - Turn the **LSB ADJUST screw on the LMO** for exact zero beat.
    - Recheck USB and repeat as needed.
14. **Dial calibration:**
    - Zero beat at 3.7 MHz and set the Zero Set dial.
    - If the hairline is off center, remove the knob and hold the LMO drive shaft with a screwdriver through the escutcheon hole.
    - Loosen the circular-dial setscrew and center 0, then retighten. **Tape the Allen wrench** so it can't short the pilot lamp socket.
    - Make sure the nylon spiral follower is engaged.

Grid drive (SB-102-3): peak for **maximum grid drive**; full-scale grid current after tune-up is normal.

Operation tune-up (pp. 117–118): - TUNE should read **50 mA** at rest. - Set FINAL loading for REL PWR 50, then advance MIC/CW for maximum. - Plate current should be about **250 mA** at maximum output. - Don't hold full output for extended periods. The **transmitter chart warns the fuse may blow if run at full TUNE output for more than 1 minute.**

4.8 Phase 7: Optional improvements (reversible)

The WB8JKR and K4JPN SB-10x improvements apply:

- 10 MΩ meter-zero resistor.
- C17 change and R6/R7 → 27 kΩ for BFO injection.

- C119 500 pF → .001 µF.
- C11 .001 → .01 µF.
- R328 470 kΩ → 1 kΩ (the R328 VOX-tone resistor is shown as 470 kΩ in Fig. 2-18).
- Sidetone fixes.
- .01 µF filament bypass.
- Multi-turn carrier-null pot.

Keep the original LMO power circuit unless PL1 or D907 cause repeated trouble.

5. Troubleshooting quick-reference

5.1 Manual troubleshooting chart (pp. 123–130), selected

#	Symptom	Key causes
4	Uneven filament/lamp voltages	Brown filament-balance leads wrong or missing
5–7	No / high / low regulated +150 V	RL2 wiring; **OA2 V18**; R304/R305; shorted bypass
10	No audio	T301; **C304 shorted or reversed**; V14; RL2 leads
13	Hum only	RFC101 open; V13; no carrier injection; T102; V3/V4
14	Noise, no signal	T201; no LMO at V12A; V3; V12A; no heterodyne at V11; V10/V11; RL1; T202; FL1; FILTER/FREQ CONTROL
16	Receiver oscillates or birdies	Board hardware and lockwashers; antenna; high supply; low cutoff bias
18	S-meter faults	R103/R105/R106/R107/R110/R115; V3/V4; AVC short; RL2 lugs; **V19 wrong type**
21–25	No RF at a stage	HV, L901, RL1 lugs, bias, finals; RFC801, V7; V6 heterodyne; V5A, C111/C402, T202
28–31	No SSB or no CW carrier	CR1–CR4; V1; V16; Y1/Y2/Y3; R6–R9, R11; C4–C8, C16, C17
33	Won’t key CW	V15; C317; D904
34–39	LMO / heterodyne faults	LMO 10 V supply; Q1; **lamp**; **D907**; Y501–Y508; V19; L601–L608; rotors 180°
40–41	VOX won’t trip / stays in	V17A; D201; **D202**; anti-trip D1/D2
42	Transmitter unstable	Neutralizing; hardware; lockwashers; L801–L805; coil cover; shield clips
43	Slow receive recovery	**D101**
44	Grid drive falls off	Heat; bias; load; **gassy 6146s**
45	Zero shifts band to band	Calibrator not exactly 100 kHz

5.2 Service bulletins

Symptom	SB-102 bulletin (→ referenced)
Meter zero / S-meter drift	-1 (→ SB-101-1), -22, -30
Heterodyne tube failures	-2 (R212 220 → 330 Ω)
Low grid drive	-3, -9, -26
LMO instability	-4; SB-101-12, -16
Low 40 m output	-5
VOX / audio	-6 (→ SB-100-3), -19, -24, -29
Instability / oscillation	-7, -9, -10
Neutralizing	-8 (→ SB-100-2), -27
Relays hang / chirp	-14, -21
AGC / IF sensitivity	-15, -23, -25
Calibrator spurs	-16
Preselector / loading	-17, -20
Carrier null	-18
Germanium diodes	-28

6. Operation notes (manual pp. 116–118)

- A 50–75 Ω non-reactive load must be connected before transmitting.
- **FREQ CONTROL:**
  - LOCKED NORMAL: transmit and receive on the LMO.
  - LOCKED AUX: both on crystal Y5.
  - UNLOCKED AUX: transmit on Y5, receive on the LMO.
  - Y5 operation is limited to about ±25 kHz of each band (Special Crystal Considerations, p. 106).
- Meter scales: S-meter 0–60 dB (ALC position, receive); REL PWR 0–10; GRID 0–1 mA; HV 0–1000 V; PLATE 0–500 mA.
- Heterodyne crystals may be **up to 1500 Hz** off nominal (p. 106). That's another reason to zero-set on the nearest calibrator point.
- **RTTY via the LMO FSK terminal requires a fan and a reduced screen voltage** (keep input ≤ 150 W; p. 116).

7. Tips and tricks

- Keep spare **#1815** lamps. A dead PL1 kills the LMO.
- Keep GE 6AU6s, a 12AT7 for V19, a 6HS6 and a matched 6146 pair.
- Never pull tubes or lamps with power on (series-parallel filaments).
- Tape the Allen wrench during dial calibration.
- Measure resistors with one lead lifted.
- Reform any electrolytics you keep with a slow ramp.

8. Maintenance schedule

Interval	Task
Each session	10–30 min warm-up; zero-set on the nearest calibrator point.
6 months	Exercise switches; METER ZERO check.
Yearly	Bias (50 mA), carrier null, grid drive; receive benchmark (S9+20 / S6); LMO jack clean.

Interval	Task
2–3 years	Neutralization check (14.2 MHz); retighten board hardware; DeoxIT.
5 years	Tube test (V3/V4/V10/V19, finals); belts; HP-23 check; C941/C942 ESR; check that PL1 glows dimly.
~15–20 years	Re-check electrolytics.

9. Parts sources

- SB-102 restoration kits (e.g. W8AOR): electrolytics including C941/C942, films, diodes, zeners, R6/R7, carrier-null pot.
- Mouser / Digi-Key; HP-23 rebuild kits.
- Heathkit-Radios and heathkit (groups.io): LMOs, crystals, dials, belts, #1815 lamps.

10. Sources

- Heath, *SB-102 Assembly Manual* 595-1058-06 (W5RKL); SB-102 LMO schematic (archive.org).
- Heath list (puck.nether.net): SB-102 bulletins (Aug 1997, Apr 1998); SB-101 and SB-100 bulletins (Apr 1998); HW-101 bulletins (Jul 1997).
- W5RKL, *Heathkit HW-101 and SB-10x Restoration and Troubleshooting*.
- K5BCQ SB-101/102 Repair Site; Nostalgic Kits Central SB-10x troubleshooting; W2PA SB-101 rebuild notes.
- Heath list threads: “SB-102 LMO” (Jun 2002, K9STH); “SB-101 vs 102” (Oct 2009).
- W8AOR SB-102 restoration kit parts list.

11. Rev. 2 change log (manual review)

Item	Rev. 1	Rev. 2 (per manual)
LMO power path	Lamp described as a **dial lamp**; “56 Ω resistor, D907, **2N3567 regulator**”	**PL1 #1815 is a voltage-dropping lamp in the LMO supply** (D106 rectifier, C941/C942, R936 → PL1 → **D907 10 V zener**). **Q1 2N3567 is an on/off switch** driven from +150 V via R941. **R928 56 Ω** terminates the LMO line (pp. 142–143).
D907	Linked to 15/10 m sensitivity (SB-101-10)	In the SB-102 it is the **LMO 10 V zener**; reversed → no LMO (chart 39B). The SB-101-10 note does not apply.
Specs	Field values only	Added the factory spec table: 0.35 µV, 100/80 W, 400 Hz electrical dial accuracy, power 700–850 V / 300 V / −115 V / 12 V @ 4.76 A (pp. 131–134).

Item	Rev. 1	Rev. 2 (per manual)
Tube list	Inferred V numbers	**Confirmed** against the circuit description; V11 = 6AU6, V5B = crystal oscillator, V16A USB / V16B LSB-CW.
Diodes	Kit cross-reference only	Full designator table: D1/D2, D101, D106, D201, **D202 15 V zener**, D301, D902/D903, D904, D905, D907, D909, CR1–4, CR201, CR901.
Electrolytics	C945 “bias filter” and voltage ratings asserted	Parts lists confirm **7 electrolytics** (2 × 500 µF, 3 × 10 µF, 2 × 20 µF) but **print no voltages**; C945 designator unverified.
R104/R105	Implied 47 Ω (HW-101 values)	**56 Ω** in the SB-102.
R116	4.7 kΩ vs 47 kΩ unresolved	**4700 Ω** (Fig. 2-25).
Pilot lamps	“#1815 dial lamp”	One #47 + three #1815 (p. 24); one #1815 is PL1.
Supply	“HP-23, 300 V”	Also: HP-23A bias control inoperative (bias set in the transceiver); HP-13A bias fully CW; 11-pin pinout; 9-terminal jumper plug required (pp. 98–100).
Initial test	Generic	Manual steps: BIAS ADJUST CCW, HV 800–900 V, +300 V at pt 5, −111 V at pt 4, LMO lamp glows dimly (p. 100).
Alignment	Shared SB/HW method	Manual sequence with TP −0.5 to −2 V (−0.3 V = dead), coil locations, T201/T102/T103, neutralizer ½-mesh start, bias 50 mA, T1, grid 0.3 mA per band, hole-W driver wire, 14.2 MHz re-neutralize, S-meter rezero on 29.5, C220 calibrator, LSB ADJUST, dial calibration (pp. 101–105).
Carrier null	Bulletin reference only	Manual’s C18 12/24 pF rotor fix (p. 104).
Troubleshooting	Bulletins only	Added the manual chart summary (§5.1).
Dial error	“3–10 kHz between points is normal”	Spec is **within 400 Hz** after calibration; the K9STH figures describe aged or out-of-spec units.